

THE PROMPT + GUIDE FROM THE VIDEO

# Clean up your AI setup.

The exact audit prompt I ran on camera, the guide you feed your AI so it helps you decide what to clean, retire and add, and a weekly check so the mess doesn't come back.

Works with Claude Code and Codex. Checked against the current docs on 17 October 2026.

START HERE

# Ten minutes of your time.

1. **Run the audit.** Copy the prompt on the next page into Claude Code or Codex, opened in your home folder.
2. **Read the web page it makes.** Start with the 10 changes.
3. **Hand your AI the guide.** Attach `CLEANUP-GUIDE.md` in the same chat and say "Use this guide to decide what to clean, retire and add. Start with the first change."
4. **Approve one change at a time.** Test each one on a real task before the next.
5. **Schedule it.** Set up the weekly check so it stays clean.

### What's in the download

| | |
|---|---|
| **Prompt** | `AUDIT-PROMPT.md` the exact prompt from the video, how to run it, and a one-tool version |
| **Guide** | `CLEANUP-GUIDE.md` written for your AI, with the three questions, what to check, one source of truth, and how to add new things |
| **Schedule** | `SCHEDULED-CLEANUP-PROMPT.md` the weekly check, plus setup steps for Codex and Claude |
| **This PDF** | All of it, laid out to read |

### What this kit never does

It installs nothing and adds nothing that loads every session. The audit only reads. The guide makes your AI ask before every change, back up first, and move things into an archive instead of deleting them.

STEP 1

# The audit prompt.

This is the exact prompt from the video. Paste it as one message.

I switch between Claude Code and Codex all the time. Look through my whole setup in both and tell me what's working, what's dead weight, and what's missing. That includes my skills, rules, instruction files, settings, plugins, connected tools, agents, and every project I run as its own system.

Don't guess what I use. Check my last 90 days of conversations in both tools. Don't read them one by one, because that's too slow. Write a quick script that counts what I actually used and finds every time I had to correct you, then work from that summary. If it helps, split the work between helpers running at the same time.

Tell me
1. What I rarely or never use, and whether to delete it, combine it, or start using it again
2. Which rules are outdated, repeated, or conflict with each other, including where my Claude and Codex instructions don't match
3. What I have set up in one tool but not the other, and how to keep both in sync from one place
4. What settings or automations I should have but don't
5. Where each of my project systems wastes my time, and the single best fix for each

Back up every point with a number or the file it came from. No general advice. Don't change anything, just report.

Give me the results as a web page I can read on my phone. Start with the 10 changes that would help me most, then a quick score for each area, then the details with what you found, the proof, and what you'd do about it.

## How to run it

Open Claude Code or Codex in a folder that can see your whole setup, like your home folder. Allow read access when it asks. On a busy setup it takes a while, because it counts 90 days of conversations.

## Only use one tool?

Swap the first sentence for

> "I use Claude Code every day. Look through my whole setup and tell me what's working, what's dead weight, and what's missing."

and drop the Codex parts of points 2 and 3.

STEP 2 · THE GUIDE YOUR AI READS

# Three questions for everything you keep.

Ask these about everything that loads in every session, and about anything new before you add it.

1. **Is it needed on most tasks?**
   Would you do worse today without it? If yes, keep it global and trim it. If not, can you emulate it? Point your AI at the skill once, pull out the one instruction that makes the difference, and add only that line. Or don't install it at all and say "Go and refer to this repo for this specific task."

2. **Is it only useful sometimes?**
   Then scope it. Load it on demand as a skill, a rule for certain files, or an instruction file in the one folder that needs it.

3. **Is it maintained?**
   Unused for months, pointing at models or paths that no longer exist, or contradicting another file. Fix it or retire it, and run the check on a schedule.

| | |
|---|---|
| **KEEP** | Needed on most tasks. Stays global, trimmed. |
| **SCOPE** | Useful sometimes. Loads on demand. |
| **EMULATE** | Replace the whole thing with the one line that matters. |
| **MERGE** | A duplicate. Keep one. |
| **FIX** | Outdated, wrong, or in conflict with another file. |
| **RETIRE** | Not used, not needed. Moves to an archive, never deleted. |
| **ADD** | Missing. You keep correcting the AI about it. |

WHAT THE GUIDE CHECKS

# Where the mess hides.

1. **What loads every session,** per tool, with line counts and sizes.
2. **Drift between tools.** A rule in Claude's files that Codex never sees, or one that says the opposite.
3. **Duplicates.** `writing-v1`, `writing-v2`, `writing-final`. The same rule in three places.
4. **Dead references.** Old model names, paths and tools that no longer exist.
5. **Junk.** macOS `._` files, empty files, backups inside working folders, another client's files.
6. **Unused** skills, plugins, connected tools and hooks, counted from 90 days of history, not guessed.
7. **Missing rules.** Any correction you gave three or more times.
8. **Maintenance.** Whether a scheduled check exists.

### The limits worth knowing (checked 17 October 2026)

**Claude Code** reads every CLAUDE.md on the path at launch. Anthropic's guidance is under 200 lines per file. Splitting with `@imports` doesn't help, because imports load at launch too. Rules in `.claude/rules/` load every session unless scoped to file paths. Skills load only when used. Run `/context` to see what loaded.

**Codex** reads your global AGENTS.md, then the AGENTS.md files from the project root down. It stops at 32 KiB combined by default, and anything past that is cut off without a warning.

ONE SOURCE OF TRUTH

# Write each rule once.

If you use more than one assistant, shared rules belong in one file that all of them read.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Codex** | Reads `AGENTS.md`. |
| **Claude Code** | Reads `AGENTS.md` by itself when there is no `CLAUDE.md` in the folder or above it (v2.1.277 or later). If you have a `CLAUDE.md`, put `@AGENTS.md` at the top and keep only Claude-specific lines under it. |
| **Gemini CLI** | Reads `GEMINI.md` by default. Add `AGENTS.md` to `context.fileName` in its `settings.json`. |

### Why small drift matters

A plane that leaves New York one degree off course doesn't land in Glasgow. One outdated line, one rule that fights another, one new skill that half overlaps an old one. Each is small. Together they pull every session off course.

### Before you add anything new

1. Would most of your tasks be worse without it? If not, don't install it globally.
2. Can your AI emulate it with one line?
3. Can you just point at it for one task?
4. If it goes in, where does it load, what does it replace, and when do you review it?

STEP 3

# The weekly check.

Run this as a scheduled task. It only moves junk, empty files and exact duplicates into an archive, never deletes, and writes a short report. Everything else waits for your approval.

This is my weekly AI setup check. Use the same scope as my setup audit: skills, rules, instruction files, settings, plugins, connected tools, agents, and every project I run as its own system, in Claude Code and in Codex.

Count what I used in the last 7 days and the last 90 days from my conversation history with a quick script, and find every time I had to correct you. Compare with last week's report in ~/ai-archive/reports/ if there is one.

You may do these without asking me, and only these:
- Move operating system junk files (._ files and .DS_Store) out of my instruction and skill folders.
- Move empty files and broken links out of those folders.
- Move exact duplicate files out, keeping the newest copy.
Move them into ~/ai-archive/<today's date>/ with a note listing where each one came from. Never delete anything. If a move is blocked, leave the file where it is, do not leave a copy in the archive, and list it in the report for me to move.

Everything else is a suggestion for me to approve. Do not edit any instruction file, rule, skill, setting or memory. Do not touch keys or tokens; if you see one in plain text, tell me the file and line without printing it.

Write the report to ~/ai-archive/reports/<today's date>.md with:
1. What you moved, and the one-line undo for each
2. What changed since last week (new files, grown files, new conflicts)
3. Anything unused for 90 days, with your keep, scope or retire call
4. Corrections I gave you three or more times (missing rules)
5. The single change you would make first, and why

Keep the report short. Back up every point with a number or a file path.

### Codex

Open **Scheduled** in the sidebar, create a task, paste the prompt, choose weekly and your home folder, then **Run now** once. Codex protects folders like `.agents`; anything it can't move lands in the report.

### Claude

Code tab, **Routines**, **New routine**, choose **Local** (a cloud routine can't see your files). Paste the prompt, choose weekly and your folder, then run it once by hand.

THAT'S IT

# Less to load.
# Better answers.

As models get better you will need fewer skills and fewer rules, not more. The setup that wins is the one you can still explain in a minute.

**Want help with yours?**

In my Early AI-dopters community I go through members' setups and send personal Loom walkthroughs for specific problems. **skool.com/earlyaidopters**

Product facts were checked against the Claude Code, Codex and Gemini CLI docs on 17 October 2026. Menus and limits change, so check the current docs if something looks different.